

Café Rush

Brand guidelines

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A ninety-second cooking rush you buy once and own forever.

This book governs every word and every colour that leaves the project with the name Café Rush on it. It is a set of vetoes, not a mood board.

Where a page here conflicts with a marketing instinct, this book wins. Where it conflicts with `docs/design-spec.md`, `docs/requirements.md`, `docs/target-player.md`, `docs/art-plan.md` or `docs/rush-pivot.md`, those documents win and this book is wrong and must be amended. That has already happened once: rule 23 originally banned the generated painted art the game actually ships, and was corrected rather than quietly ignored.

The colour pages are generated from `assets/colour/tokens.json` by `build-tokens.py`, and this document is generated by `build-guidelines.py`. Nothing in either is typed by hand twice, so the book and the stylesheet a developer imports cannot drift apart.

The one rule under all the others

A hex value that is not a token is a bug. A sentence with an exclamation mark in it is a bug. A second thing for sale is a breach of contract with the player.

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A ninety-second cooking rush you buy once and own forever.

Ninety-second cooking rush

Tells a genre-literate player exactly what this is — seats filling, patience draining, machines running on their own timers behind you. Nobody arrives expecting a calm farming sim and leaves a one-star review saying so.

Buy once

The whole commercial model in two words: a free first chapter, then one payment of AED 24.99, and nothing else is ever for sale.

Own forever

The longevity claim and the anti-FOMO claim at once. Thirty days, ninety stars and an Endless Rush that does not end — none of it expiring, none of it requiring you to show up on a Tuesday.

IT RULES OUT THREE THINGS WE WILL BE TEMPTED BY

Calling this cozy. The player liked the fast one. Mis-selling the pace puts the game in front of exactly the wrong audience.

A second purchase. "Once" and "forever" are the promise, and the first expiring offer makes us liars.

Selling on production value. The promise is about the deal and the loop, not about how the croissant is painted.

For the **lapsed Dash player** who finished the cooking games they loved and was disappointed that they ended, Café Rush is the **premium time-management game** that gives you **the whole rush** – thirty days, twelve recipes and an endless shift – **for one payment**, unlike Cooking Fever, Cooking Madness and every frenzy clone whose pacing exists to sell gems, **because a shift tuned to be fair pays for itself at AED 24.99 and a shift tuned to be frustrating pays for itself in gems.**

For the lapsed Dash player

Not "casual mobile gamers". A specific person who played the Dash series, liked it, and whose loudest complaint was that it was finished pretty fast. We position against that disappointment, not against a demographic.

The premium time-management game

Not "cooking game", a shelf so crowded the word carries no meaning. Not "cozy", a genre this product is not in. Premium is load-bearing: the price model is the differentiator.

Because the incentives differ

The reason clause is a business fact, not a claim about our character. We took the money up front, so we have no reason to make day nineteen unfair.

She has a phone full of games she has stopped opening. She liked Diner Dash — genuinely liked it, played it properly, got fast at it — and when it ended she went looking for the next one and found a wall of games that looked the same and behaved completely differently.

One made her wait four hours for a kitchen to be built. One sold a gem-purchased speed boost that was the only way to clear level thirty-one. One wanted her to ask three friends for a key. Two played a thirty-second unskippable video between shifts. She uninstalled all of them, and what she wrote afterwards was not a rant about capitalism. It was a request: **something in this genre, that lasts a while, that does not require her to show up.**

She plays a few hours a week. Sometimes a fortnight passes, and she needs that to cost her nothing — no broken streak, no expired event, no withered crops. She will pay, and she framed it the way most people do: a few dollars, to make the ads go away. She is worth exactly one purchase, and the business depends on that purchase being good enough that she buys the next game too.

She is fast. This matters more than anything else on this page and it is the thing we will most often get wrong. She wants overlapping timers, a full counter, a customer going red at seat three while the dough is still four seconds out. She did not reject the pace. She rejected the scaffolding bolted to it.

She is not

- A cozy-game player who wants a gentle evening — she asked for the Dash games by name.
- A completionist who will grind ninety stars out of obligation. She will grind them because the run is good.
- A whale, a subscriber, a daily-active-user, a retention cohort or a funnel.
- A child.
- A lapsed player we get to win back with a notification.
- Waiting for us. If day nineteen is unfair or day six ends in a pop-up, she closes the app and never thinks about it again.

Café Rush refuses, permanently and in the shipped binary:

✗ **Energy, stamina and lives**

A ninety-second shift behind a four-hour meter is the specific insult that started this project. Any shift replays immediately, forever.

✗ **Premium currency**

One currency, AED, earned by playing. It cannot be bought, gifted, topped up or traded.

✗ **Paywalled accessibility**

Relaxed Timing is free, always available, and earns full stars and full progression.

✗ **Ads**

Not interstitial, not banner, not rewarded, not “optional” rewarded. The binary contains no ad SDK.

✗ **Notifications that ask her back**

Off by default. The only permitted notification is a local reminder she set herself.

✗ **Build queues and real-time waits**

Every upgrade applies the instant it is bought. Nothing completes in 2h.

✗ **Paywalled difficulty**

No purchase, ad, consumable or boost may make a shift easier, extend a timer, skip a day or raise earnings.

✗ **Social gating**

No invites, no keys from friends, no guild requirement, no share-to-continue.

✗ **Daily rewards and expiring content**

Anything earnable today is earnable in six months, identically.

✗ **Discount countdowns**

The price is the price.

WHY THE REFUSAL IS THE BRAND, AND NOT A FEATURE LIST

Every one of those patterns is individually profitable, and a brand is only what you turn down when it costs you something. A feature list is a set of things we built. This is a set of things we were offered and declined — a rewarded-ad button is perhaps three days of work and a measurable revenue line, and we will not ship it in year four either. The player cannot verify our intentions, but she can verify a binary with no ad SDK in it, and she can verify that the store page still says one purchase eighteen months after launch. That verifiability is the asset. It is fragile in exactly one direction: it survives a bad review, and it does not survive us doing it once.

Fast

The product's first quality: overlapping timers, a counter that fills, ninety seconds that feel shorter than ninety seconds.

Everything we make should move at that pace, including the sentences.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

frantic

Frantic is chaos the player cannot read. Fast is chaos the player can read and is only just keeping up with.

Plain

We say the number, the price, the recipe and the reason. A hint tells you what to do; a failure card tells you what happened.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

blunt

Blunt is telling a player they were too slow. Plain is telling them the dough takes five seconds.

Warm

The café is lamp-lit at dusk, the palette is amber on ink, and the street outside is a real place with karak and luqaimat on it. Warmth is in the light and the food, never in the tone of voice.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

cozy

Cozy is a promise of no pressure, and this game is made of pressure. We are warm and difficult at once, which is what a good kitchen is.

Specific

Regag rolls, not “flatbread snack”. Saffron karak, not “premium tea”. Ninety seconds, not “fast-paced action”. AED 24.99, not “affordable”.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

exotic

We are not presenting the UAE as a setting to be marvelled at; it is simply where the shop is, and a regag roll needs no more explanation than a croissant.

Honest

We state what the game does not do — no in-shift screen-reader support in v1.0, thirty days and then Endless, thirty minutes free. Naming our limits is the same instinct that made us name our refusals.

OFTEN CONFUSED WITH

humble

We are not apologising for the scope. We chose it, and we will defend it.

1 **British English, sentence case**

Oxford comma off. Serial commas only where meaning requires them.

2 **Second person, present tense**

“You hold the milk”, not “players can hold milk”.

3 **No exclamation marks**

In any player-facing string, including result cards and purchase confirmations. The excitement is in the clock, not the punctuation.

4 **No hype adjectives**

Amazing, epic, ultimate, addictive, insane, crazy, satisfying, relaxing and stunning are banned. If a line survives their deletion, it did not need them.

5 **Numbers are real and specific**

90 seconds, 30 days, 12 recipes, 8 machines, AED 24.99. Never “hundreds of levels”, never a number we have not counted.

6 **Never imply urgency the game does not have**

No “now”, “today”, “don’t miss”, “limited”, “hurry”. The only clock runs inside a shift.

7 **Failure copy is diagnostic**

Name what happened, in the player’s own run, in one line. Never scold, never console, never say “oops”.

8 **Never ask the player to come back**

In any channel, ever.

9 **Local words stand on their own**

Karak, luqaimat, regag, istikana. Glossed exactly once in the recipe list; never glossed again, never italicised, never in quotes.

10 **Length**

UI lines are twelve words or fewer. Store paragraphs are four sentences or fewer. Hints are one sentence.

11 **ALL CAPS is a typographic style, not a voice**

Only the 9 pt label style is uppercase — DAY, EARNED, TARGET, STREAK. Nothing else shouts.

12 **Arabic is the voice in Arabic**

Not a translation of it. Dish names use the local term — كرك, لقيمات, رقاق — reviewed by a Gulf-Arabic speaker. The Arabic build is never the afterthought build.

CONTEXT	WRONG	RIGHT
Store listing, opening line	Get ready for the ultimate cooking adventure! Serve delicious dishes to hungry customers in this addictive time-management game!	Ninety seconds. Five seats. The dough takes five of those seconds, so you start it before anyone orders it.
In-game hint	Tip: Try to plan ahead and be efficient with your time to maximise your score!	Pastry takes 4.0 seconds. Start it before the order lands.
Failure message	Oh no! You failed! Better luck next time — why not try again?	Day 9 · AED 640 of 780. Four customers walked out at seat 2 while the plate was full.
Upgrade description	Supercharge your café with lightning-fast machines and watch your profits soar!	Bigger bins — the tea machine holds 5 instead of 3. Cook two ahead during a quiet stretch.
Push notification	 Your customers miss you! Come back and claim your daily bonus before it expires!	Reminder you set for Sundays at 19:00. Café Rush is where you left it.
Error	Something went wrong :(Please try again later.	The App Store did not respond. Your progress is saved on this phone. Try Restore Purchases in Settings.
Tutorial step	Tap the glowing button to cook a shot! Great job! You're a natural!	Tap Shot to start one. It takes 2.2 seconds and waits in the bin until you need it.
Thank-you after purchase	Thank you for your purchase! Enjoy your amazing new content and happy cooking!	Bought. Days 7 to 30 are open, Endless Rush is unlocked, and that was the only purchase in this game.
Paywall card, day 6	Unlock the FULL experience! Limited-time launch price — don't miss out!	That was chapter one. AED 24.99 opens the other 24 days, 6 recipes, 2 machines and Endless Rush. One payment. No ads, no currency, nothing else to buy.
Endless Rush result	WOW! Incredible run! Can you beat your friends' scores?	Wave 14. Personal best was wave 12. Three walked out in the last forty seconds.
Settings, analytics toggle	Help us improve your experience by sharing anonymous usage data!	Send anonymous play data. Off by default. Nothing identifying, no advertising, and the game works identically either way.
Recipe list entry	Saffron Karak — a luxurious and exotic Middle-Eastern tea experience!	Saffron karak — tea, milk, syrup, date paste. AED 34. Nine taps, the longest order on the menu.

The right-hand column is not a nicer version of the left. It is the same information with the selling removed, which is why it is shorter every time.

Keep Café Rush. The subtitle carries the load.

What it gets right

Two words, five syllables, and both halves work. *Café* places the setting and signals food without claiming a cuisine, which matters when the menu is karak and luqaimat. *Rush* is the honest word for the loop, and the name should not quietly re-open the argument that pivot settled. It is pronounceable in Arabic and English, short enough for a 48 dp icon at two lines, and sits well in the display face.

What it risks

Genre crowding is real: *rush*, *dash*, *fever*, *frenzy* and *madness* are the standard vocabulary of this shelf. Searchability is the sharper problem — nobody searches for a name they have never heard, so the name contributes almost nothing to discovery on its own.

Why we keep it

A distinctive name nobody searches is a worse problem than a familiar name in a crowded field, because the name is not the discovery mechanism — the subtitle, the keywords and the screenshots are. Our differentiator is the price model, and that goes in the subtitle where it is indexed and read.

What the subtitle must do, in this order

State the commercial model, because it is the only thing about this product a competitor's listing cannot also claim. Carry the anti-brand in words a scanning player recognises from their own frustration. Say nothing about quality, because every listing says that and none of it is read. It must not describe the gameplay, and it must not contain an adjective.

APP STORE TITLE — 23 OF 30

Café Rush: Cooking Game

APP STORE SUBTITLE — 29 OF 30

No ads. No timers. One price.

The word “Cooking” is in the title for one reason: the title field is a search index, not a headline. The subtitle is the headline, and it is the only line in this book permitted to sell by negation.

Café

The accent is kept. Store search normalises diacritics, “Cafe Rush” looks like a typo, and the é is a quiet promise that the details were attended to. It is set in `amber-500` in the wordmark, and in plain type everywhere else.

**On paper**

Amber becomes `amber-700`. The lighter amber does not hold at text weight on a light ground.

**Stacked**

For square and near-square spaces. Line break after Café, never a hyphen, never three lines.

**Lockup**

Icon at cap height beside the mark, on one optical baseline. Gap is one-fifth of the icon width.

**Mono**

One-colour reproduction only: embroidery, engraving, a single-ink print. Never used when colour is available.

FACE

Bricolage Grotesque 800

TRACKING

-0.045em

THE É

`amber-500` on ink,
`amber-700` on paper

CLEARSPACE

the cap height of the R, on
all four sides

MINIMUM WIDTH

96 px screen, 24 mm print

The wordmark is never all-caps, never letter-spaced, never outlined, never stretched, never gradiented, never shadowed, and never placed on a ground other than `ink-900`, `ink-950` or `paper-100`. The one permitted effect is a `sun-300` glow behind it on key art, at 12% or less.



X Never all-caps



X Never letter-spaced



X Never stretched



X Never gradiented



X Never shadowed or glowing



X Never on a coloured ground



X Never outlined



X Never reset in another face



One istikana glass of karak, lit from the left, on **ink-900** with the counter falling away behind it. No wordmark, no character, no badge.

The icon is read at 48 dp in a grid of sixty others, which is why it carries one object and one light source. The glass is the most recognisable silhouette on the menu and the only one that is unmistakably this street rather than any café.

The Android adaptive pair inset the artwork to a 66% safe zone and sit it on a flat **#AB5C1D** background sampled from the icon itself, because the launcher may crop to a circle, a squircle or a rounded square and we do not get to choose which.



180



120



87



58



40



29



adaptive fg



adaptive bg

33 files ship: 18 iOS, 10 Android including the adaptive pair and the Play 512, and 5 for web and favicon use. Never re-derive one by scaling another in a document — every size is exported from the 1024 master.

10 Colour — the brand is amber on ink

CAFÉ RUSH — BRAND GUIDELINES

PRIMARY



ink-900 #171310
Brand ground. App, store graphics, press page, slides, social
NEVER Never lightened for readability, never pure black
on ink-900 1.0:1 · on paper-100 17.2:1



amber-500 #F2A03D
Brand primary. The wordmark's e, primary fill, the + glyph, the clock bar
NEVER Never money. Never a field larger than a button
on ink-900 8.7:1 · on paper-100 2.0:1



amber-400 #FFBC63
Focus ring, active highlight, cook-ready flash, lit edge of the wordmark
NEVER Never a fill for body type on cream
on ink-900 11.1:1 · on paper-100 1.6:1



amber-700 #C97C22
Pressed and active, and amber on light grounds
NEVER Never at rest, never in marketing
on ink-900 5.6:1 · on paper-100 3.0:1



ink-950 #0E0B09
Modal scrims at 72%, contact shadows, type set on amber
NEVER Never the app background
on ink-900 1.1:1 · on paper-100 18.2:1

SECONDARY — THE STREET



terracotta-600 #A8452A
Awning, wall band, dusk sky, the CLOSED stamp
NEVER Never a button, warning or state
on ink-900 3.1:1 · on paper-100 5.5:1



terracotta-400 #C9603C
Brand-only. Large flat marketing fields where -600 goes muddy
NEVER Never in the game, never beside state-urgent
on ink-900 4.6:1 · on paper-100 3.7:1



brass-400 #E8C36B
Money and only money: coins, AED figures, tips, takings, the listed price
NEVER Never a button, decoration or headline
on ink-900 10.9:1 · on paper-100 1.6:1



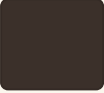
tile-500 #3E6E6B
The one cool note: the tile band, and one accent per composition
NEVER Never more than one element per composition
on ink-900 3.2:1 · on paper-100 5.3:1



sun-300 #F4D9A8
Window light, lamp glow, steam, the glow behind the wordmark at <=12%
NEVER Never type, never a control fill
on ink-900 13.5:1 · on paper-100 1.3:1

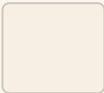
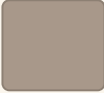
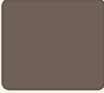
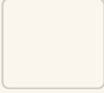
10 Colour — surface, type and state

SURFACES AND EDGES

	ink-850 Plate well, inset wells	#1E1815
	ink-800 Panel, card, ticket, bin	#231C18
	ink-700 Raised panel, chip tile, meter track	#2E2521
	ink-600 Default 1 pt edge	#3B302A
	ink-500 Raised edge, rim light	#4A3C34
	ink-450 Edge of a bin holding stock	#5A4A3A

Never more than three surface steps in one composition, in a slide as much as in a scene file.

TYPE, PAPER AND THE OUTLINE

	cream-50 Primary type on ink, ready-state ring, sprite highlights	#F7EFE3
	cream-200 Secondary emphasis	#D9C9B6
	cream-400 Secondary text, dish names	#A8988A
	cream-600 Tertiary text, disabled, micro-labels	#6F6058
	paper-100 Brand-only. Print, press kit, the one-page site, a light shelf	#FBF6ED
	ink-outline The one outline colour on all art, in game and in marketing	#2A1D16

These are learned in the first shift and must mean the same thing everywhere, including in a screenshot on a store page.

	state-calm Patience >= 55%, cooking in progress NEVER Anything monetary on ink-900 6.4:1 · on paper-100 2.7:1	#5B9DD9
	state-soon Patience 25-55%, recoverable warning NEVER Idle decoration on ink-900 8.7:1 · on paper-100 2.0:1	#F2A03D
	state-urgent Patience < 25%, walkout, failure NEVER Food, buttons at rest, any marketing field on ink-900 4.6:1 · on paper-100 3.7:1	#E24B2E
	ok-500 Money earned and targets met NEVER Urgency, readiness, timers on ink-900 8.0:1 · on paper-100 2.1:1	#4FBF7B
	focus-500 Focus ring, 2 pt, 2 pt offset NEVER Anything else on ink-900 11.1:1 · on paper-100 1.6:1	#FFBC63

Why blue → amber → red, and never green → red

Patience runs from **state-calm** blue through **state-soon** amber to **state-urgent** red. Green is never a patience colour, because roughly one man in twelve cannot separate it from red, and because green in this product means one thing only: money earned and target met.

PATIENCE, FULL TO EMPTY



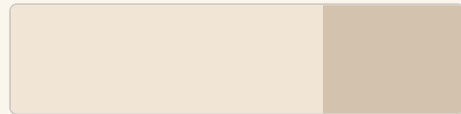
The two absolutes

brass-400 is money and nothing else. **ok-500** is money earned and target met and nothing else. The rule is absolute because the player learns it in ninety seconds, and a single decorative use unteaches it.

10 Colour — art fills and identity

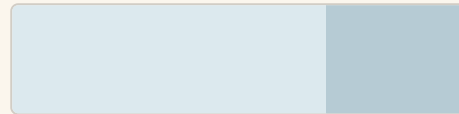
LIGHT FILL SET

The only fills permitted to dominate a sprite's silhouette. All are $L^* \geq 70$ and separate cleanly from `ink-900`. Each ships with its shade partner, and a sprite uses the pair or neither.



fill-porcelain

#F1E6D6 · #D3C3AE



fill-glass

#DCE9EE · #B6CBD4



fill-dough

#E8C79A · #C4914F



fill-steel

#CFCAC2 · #A7A099



fill-honey

#E7B24C · #BE8524



fill-linen

#E3D8C6 · #C2B49A

ACCENT FILLS

Small internal areas only — under 40% of a silhouette.



espresso

#4A2A1C



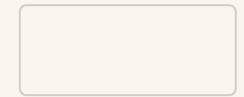
tea

#C98A4E



mint

#7FB86B



milk

#FAF6EE



karak

#C98A4E



ice-core

#AFD4E4



almond

#D8B27E

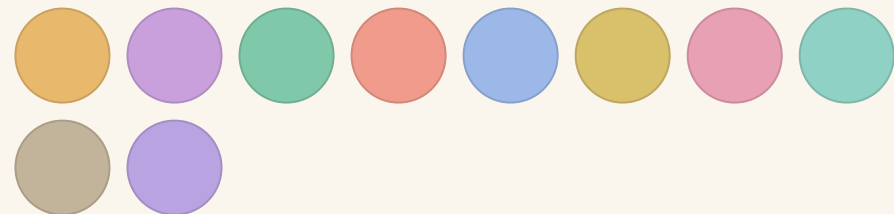


date

#6B3B23

CUSTOMER IDENTITY CHIPS

Decorative identity only, never state. A customer whose chip is red must not read as urgent. All test $\geq 4.5:1$ against `ink-900` and carry `ink-950` initials. They belong to individual customers, never to us — a chip colour is not a brand colour.



Café Rush

Bricolage Grotesque 800

Wordmark, headlines, screen titles, money totals, button labels, floating payments. 600 for subheads and standfirsts only, where 800 at that size would dominate the headline above it.

The dough takes five seconds

DM Sans 400 / 500 / 700

Running copy, hints, dish names, shop descriptions, settings, store descriptions, documents.

AED 24.99

0:90

×3

DM Mono 400 / 500

Clocks, timers, stock counts, prices, and every uppercase label style.

ARABIC

Cairo 700 / 900 for the Arabic wordmark and all Arabic headlines, set at the same optical weight as Bricolage 800 and never lighter. **IBM Plex Sans Arabic 400 / 500 / 600** for all Arabic running copy and numerals, with `font-feature-settings: "tnum"`. Latin and Arabic lockups are built as two designs, not one flipped.

LICENSING

All five faces are SIL Open Font License, which is why they can ship inside the binary, inside a PDF and inside a web page without a per-seat count. The embedded set lives at `brand/fonts/fonts.css` — sixteen faces as data URIs, so a press kit renders correctly on a machine that has none of them installed.

11 Typography — the scale

THE IN-GAME SCALE IS AUTHORITATIVE

display-xl	Bricolage 800	34 / 36	Screen titles, the day's takings
display-l	Bricolage 800	29 / 31	Result headline
display-m	Bricolage 800	22 / 24	Card titles, dish price
display-s	Bricolage 800	17 / 20	Button labels
body-l	DM Sans 400	15 / 22	Running copy
body-m	DM Sans 400	13 / 19	Hints, descriptions
body-s	DM Sans 400	11.5 / 17	Dense list rows
num-l	DM Mono 500	20 / 22	Clock, cash total
num-m	DM Mono 500	14 / 18	Stock counts, timers
num-s	DM Mono 400	11 / 14	Inline counts
label	DM Mono 500	9 / 12, +0.14em	DAY, EARNED, TARGET, STREAK

ABOVE DISPLAY-XL, MULTIPLY

Brand headlines continue the same ratio — 34, 48, 68, 96 — line-height 1.05 throughout, and nothing between those steps. Below `label`, nothing.

96 68 48 34

The floor

Minimum rendered size anywhere, in any medium, is 9 pt, and only for `label`. Nothing a player must read while the clock runs is below 11 pt. That applies to a banner and a slide exactly as it applies to a shift.

11 Typography — setting a headline

- 1 Bricolage 800, tracking -0.02em at 22 pt and above, -0.01em from 17 to 21 pt, 0 below. Never positive tracking in Bricolage.
- 2 Maximum two lines. A headline that needs three is a headline that needs cutting.
- 3 Ragged right, never justified, never centred over more than one line. Break lines on meaning, not on width.
- 4 Sentence case always. The wordmark is Café Rush with the é, in both cases and at every size.
- 5 Never all-caps, never letter-spaced, never outlined, never stretched, never gradiented, never shadowed. The one permitted effect is a `sun-300` glow behind the wordmark on key art, at 12% or less.
- 6 `cream-50` on `ink-900`, or `ink-900` on `paper-100`. Amber headlines only when the headline is one word.
- 7 Numerals inside a headline stay in Bricolage. Numerals that are data — a price, a clock, a count — switch to DM Mono, always. A price in a headline is data.
- 8 Arabic headlines set in Cairo 900 at the same optical weight as Bricolage 800, never lighter.
- 9 Minimum rendered size anywhere, in any medium: 9 pt, and only for `label`.

BREAKING ON MEANING

RIGHT

**A ninety-second cooking rush
you buy once and own forever.**

The break falls between the two claims. Each line is a complete thought.

WRONG

**A ninety-second cooking rush
you buy
once and own forever.**

The break falls where the measure ran out. “You buy” dangles.

12 Art direction

DISHES — TWELVE



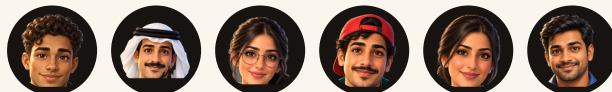
INGREDIENTS — EIGHT



MACHINES — SIX



CUSTOMERS — TWELVE, SIX SHOWN



Forty-one assets: eight ingredients, twelve dishes, twelve customer portraits, six machines, three room plates. Glossy, appetising painted illustration with soft airbrushed shading and crisp specular highlights — warm and inviting, not photographic and not flat vector.

They must look like one artist made all of them in one sitting. A single asset that is beautiful alone but sits at a different angle, scale or light direction ruins the set, so consistency outranks any individual image. Light falls from the upper left throughout.

Each is cut from its backdrop by a flood fill inward from the edges rather than a colour threshold, so an object's own mid-greys survive. Portraits are cropped to the head — a bust at 40 px leaves a 16 px face — and faded rather than cut, so the crop reads as a vignette.

Marketing art is the shipped art

Every dish, machine, portrait and room in a banner or press image is a file from `art/sprites/`, at or below its rendered size in the build. No stock photography, no separately commissioned key art, nothing drawn at a fidelity the game does not contain. `ink-outline` is the only stroke colour anywhere.

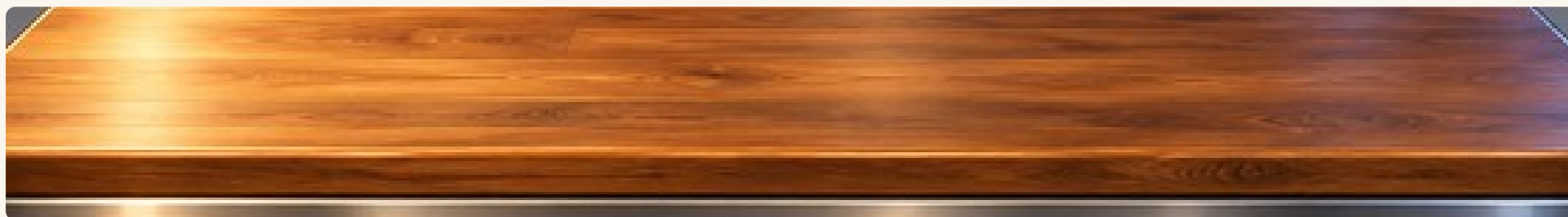
12 Art direction — the room



room_day — the shift

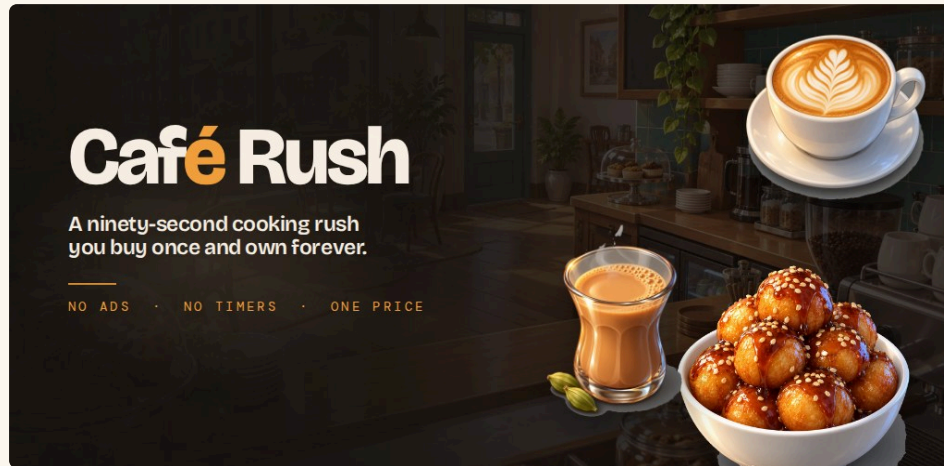


room_evening — results, menus, key art

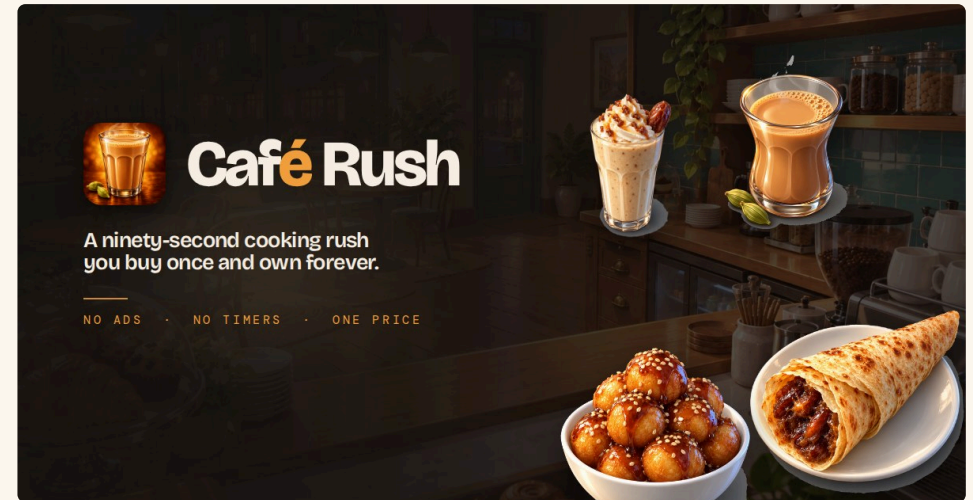


room_counter — the working band

Three plates, one room, three times of day. A plate is always pushed back behind the interface — darkened, slightly desaturated, and never competing with a sprite the player must read. In marketing it carries a scrim at 55–97% so type sits on `ink-900`, not on a photograph.



Google Play feature graphic · 1024 × 500



Social and Open Graph banner · 1200 × 630

The structure

Copy left, food right, always. Type never sits over a sprite and a sprite never sits over type.

The ground

A room plate at 62% brightness under an `ink-900` scrim, plus a `sun-300` glow at 12% behind the mark.

The copy

Wordmark, the promise broken on meaning, a 52 px amber rule, then the subtitle as a mono label. Nothing else.

The one accent

`amber-500` appears twice: the é and the rule. One cool note per composition is permitted; two is not.

TITLE — 23 OF 30

Café Rush: Cooking Game

SUBTITLE — 29 OF 30

No ads. No timers. One price.

PROMOTIONAL TEXT — 165 OF 170

The first chapter is free. If the ninety seconds grab you, one payment of AED 24.99 opens the other twenty-four days. No ads, no gems, no energy, no second purchase.

KEYWORD FIELD — 93 OF 100

diner,restaurant,chef,time
management,karak,offline,premium,tycoon,dash,uae,arabi
c,food,serve

Cooking, café, rush, ads, timers and price are deliberately absent — Apple indexes the title and subtitle already, and repeating them wastes the hundred characters.

DESCRIPTION — OPENING

Ninety seconds. Five seats filling at once. The dough takes five of those seconds, which means you start it before anyone has ordered it — and that is the whole game. Machines cook ingredients on their own timers into bins behind you; dishes are assembled from that stock in an instant. Being fast is not the skill. Holding the right thing before it is asked for is the skill.

Why the opening paragraph is a mechanic, not a mood

The scanning player has read a thousand openings that promise excitement. She has never read one that told her the dough takes five seconds. Specificity is how a small game sounds confident next to a big one, and it is the only opening that a competitor with a bigger budget cannot copy without changing their game.

14 Store listing — the description

You run a small café on a shopping street in the UAE. Karak chai, luqaimat, regag rolls, saffron karak, and nine more recipes across thirty days. Customers sit down, order up to three things, and lose patience at their own pace. The counter holds only a few plates and a full counter blocks you, so starting the wrong machine is a mistake, not a delay.

Thirty days in five chapters. Each chapter adds something the last one could not do: regulars with a usual order, food that goes cold, customers who change their mind, a machine that breaks mid-shift. Day nineteen is not day four with a faster clock.

Then Endless Rush, which does not end. One continuous shift that steps up every twenty-five seconds until three customers walk out. Your own best run is the only score that matters.

The first chapter is free — six days, six recipes, about half an hour, with a proper ending rather than a locked door. If you want the rest, it is one payment of AED 24.99.

Seven paragraphs, none longer than four sentences, no exclamation mark, no adjective doing sales work, and one stated limitation. The limitation is not an oversight — a listing that omits it to look cleaner has broken rule 9.

That is the only purchase in this game.

No ads of any kind. No energy meter. No premium currency. No daily rewards, no login streaks, no limited-time events, nothing that expires. Nothing you can buy makes a shift easier. No friends required, no account, no internet — it plays in aeroplane mode forever. Put it down for a month and it is exactly where you left it.

Relaxed Timing is free and earns full stars. Three colour-blind palettes, high contrast, larger text, reduced motion, left-handed layout. In-shift screen-reader play is not supported in this version, and we would rather say so than claim it.

English and Arabic, both fully laid out right-to-left where they should be.

The list that holds when someone is in a hurry. Every line is a veto, not a preference. These nine are contractual rather than stylistic: breaking one is not a design mistake, it is a breach of the deal the player paid into.

- | | | | |
|---|---|---|--|
| 1 | There is never a second thing for sale. One non-consumable at AED 24.99, forever. Paid expansions, if they ever ship, are self-contained, separately titled, and never required to finish what a player already owns. | 2 | No ad SDK is ever linked into the binary, including for attribution or analytics. |
| 3 | No premium currency, no consumable, no boost, no subscription, no season, no battle pass. | 4 | Nothing purchasable ever makes a shift easier, and nothing that makes a shift easier is ever purchasable. |
| 5 | No discount countdown, no launch-week urgency, no “price rises soon”. A price change is announced plainly and without a deadline. | 6 | No daily reward, streak, event, or expiring content of any kind. If it can be earned today, it can be earned in six months, identically. |
| 7 | No notification that asks a player to come back. Notifications are off by default and only ever a reminder the player set themselves. | 8 | No leaderboard, invite, share-to-continue, account requirement or online dependency. |
| 9 | The store listing never states a claim the binary does not honour, and never omits a limitation to make the listing cleaner. | | |

15 The rules — verbal and visual

VERBAL

- 10 No exclamation marks in player-facing strings. None.
- 11 The banned words are banned in every channel: amazing, epic, ultimate, addictive, insane, crazy, satisfying, relaxing, stunning, unlock the fun, get ready.
- 12 The game is never described as cozy, casual, relaxing or calm. It is a rush.
- 13 No invented number ever appears — no download counts, no ratings we have not received, no market statistics, no “loved by thousands”.
- 14 Failure copy never scolds, consoles or apologises. It says what happened.
- 15 Local dish names are never glossed twice, never italicised, never framed as exotic.
- 16 The Arabic build is never shipped late, never machine-translated, and never shown with English screenshots.

VISUAL

- 17 A hex value that is not a `docs/design-spec.md` §2.3 token — or `terracotta-400` / `paper-100` — never appears in any asset, in the game or out of it.
- 18 `brass-400` is money and nothing else. `ok-500` is money earned and target met and nothing else. `state-urgent` never touches food, a resting button or a marketing field.
- 19 `ink-outline` `#2A1D16` is the only stroke colour on any artwork anywhere.
- 20 The wordmark is Bricolage Grotesque 800, sentence case, with the é. Never all-caps, letter-spaced, outlined, stretched, gradiented or shadowed, and never on a ground other than `ink-900`, `ink-950` or `paper-100`.
- 21 Headlines are never longer than two lines and never centred over more than one.
- 22 No screenshot is ever mocked up, upscaled, composited from art we do not ship, or taken from a build with features the store version does not have. What is on the store page is what installs.
- 23 Marketing art is the shipped art — a file from `art/sprites/`, at or below its rendered size in the build. No stock photography, no photographic food, no separately commissioned key art, nothing drawn at a fidelity the game does not contain.
- 24 Nothing flashes more than three times a second, in the game or in a trailer.
- 25 Nothing ever renders below 9 pt, and nothing below 11 pt that a player must read while the clock runs.

FILES

brand/guidelines.pdf	This document, 28 pages, fonts embedded
brand/strategy.md	The long-form strategy these pages compress
brand/fonts/fonts.css	16 faces as data URIs. Drop-in for a press page
assets/colour/tokens.css	30 core tokens, 6 art fills, 8 accent fills
assets/colour/tokens.json	The same, with contrast ratios and never-rules
assets/colour/swatches-*.png	Six swatch sheets, one per group
assets/logo/	7 wordmark and lockup variants, dark, light and mono
assets/icon/ios/	18 sizes, 29 to 1024, from one master
assets/icon/android/	10 files including the adaptive pair and Play 512
assets/icon/web/	5 favicon and web-manifest sizes
assets/marketing/	Play feature graphic, social and OG banner
art/sprites/	41 game assets at 512, plus @34 and @20 game sizes

REGENERATING

Nothing in this kit is edited by hand. `build-tokens.py` writes the stylesheet, the JSON and the swatch source from one table. `build-guidelines.py` writes this document from that JSON plus the strategy copy. `render-guidelines.js` drives headless Chromium to produce the PDF and the swatch sheets. Change the table, run the three, and the book, the stylesheet and the swatches move together.

What is not here yet

Store screenshots, which must be taken from a real build rather than mocked up, and the trailer. Both are blocked on the same thing: rule 22 means we cannot make them until the build shows what they would show.

Café Rush

A ninety-second cooking rush you buy once and own forever.